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No. 400 — 406

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Date 6/12/80

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Subject

पुर्व निर्देश
Previous reference

बाद का निर्देश
Later reference

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18⁷².

Foreign Department.

Political A.

Progs. *December* 18⁷², Nos. 400/406.

pages, with Notes.

Subject.

*Account of the tenets of the Ibadhi Sect of Oman,
translated from an Arabic M. S. by Lieut: Colonel
Ross, Political Agent, Muscat.*

For references to former and later Cases see within the cover.

REFERENCES TO FORMER CASES.

Rf. R. Nos.
No. 1557P.

GOVT. OF
INDIA. }

1872

{ FOREIGN
DEPT.

POLITICAL-A

DECEMBER.

REFERENCES TO LATER CASES.

Rf. R. Nos.

Nos. 400-406.

*Account of the tenets of the Ibadhi Sect of Oman,
translated from an Arabic M.S. by Lieutenant-
Colonel Ross, Political Agent, Muscat.*

LIST OF PAPERS.

TAKEEDS.

Nos. 400-403.—From Bombay Govt., No. 6273 of 31st
Oct. 1872—Forwards a paper giving an
account of the above.

Enelo. to above.

No. 404.—To Bombay Govt., No. 2383P. of 23rd Dec.
1872—In reply, requests that the thanks of
Govt. may be communicated to Colonel Ross
for his valuable and interesting translation of
the Arabic work above mentioned.

No. 405.—To the Secy. to the Calcutta Asiatic Society
and the Secy. to the Public Library, Nos. 2384-
2385P. of 23rd December 1872—Forwarding
the above paper.

No. 406.—To Secy. of State, No. 249 of 27th Dec. 1872—
Forwarding Bombay Govt.'s letter, submitting
the above.

KEEP-WITHS PRINTED.

Note, Nos. 400-406.

KEEP-WITHS NOT PRINTED.

E. N. C.

Exd.—T. Y.

1872
FOREIGN DEPARTMENT.

POLITICAL—A

*Account of the tenets of the Ibadhi Sect of Oman,
translated from an Arabic manuscript by
Lieutenant-Colonel Ross, Political
Agent, Muscat.*

K. W.

PROCEEDINGS, DECEMBER,
Nos. 400-406.

From Bombay Government,
No. 6273, dated 31st October 1872.

Account of the tenets of the Ibadhi Sect of Oman, translated
from an Arabic manuscript by Lieutenant-Colonel Ross,
Political Agent, Muscat.

LIEUTENANT-COLONEL ROSS may be thanked for his
valuable and interesting translation and preface to the same.
Copies have been given to the Press by the Government of
Bombay. This may be reported to the Secretary of State,
and copies sent to Calcutta Asiatic Society and Public Library.

(Sd.) P. D. H.

13-12-72.

(Sd.) C. U. A.

14-12-72.

No. 400.

No. 6273, dated Bombay Castle, 31st October 1872.

From—Secretary to the Government of Bombay,

To—Secretary to the Government of India, Foreign Dept., with the G.-G.

I HAVE the honor, by direction of His Excellency the Governor in Council, to forward to you, for submission to the Government of India, the enclosed paper giving an account of the tenets of Ibadhi sect of Oman, translated from an Arabic manuscript work by Lieutenant-Colonel Ross, Political Agent at Muscat.

No. 401.

No. 1294-344, dated Bushire, 9th August 1872.

From—Her Britannic Majesty's Political Resident in the Persian Gulf,

To—Secretary to the Government of Bombay.

I HAVE the honor to transmit a very interesting account of the "Tenets of the Ibadhi sect of Oman," which Lieutenant-Colonel Ross has translated from a "Manuscript Arabic work entitled 'The Keshf-ul-Ghummeh of the Sheikh Sirhan bin Said bin Sirhan bin Mohammed-el-Alawi, a native of Oman,' " and which he has prefaced with an able Memorandum, appending to the work itself some valuable notes.

2. Lieutenant-Colonel Ross bears full and just testimony to the high merits of the recent able work of the Reverend G. P. Badger on the "History of the Imams and Seyyids of Oman."

3. I may mention that an Arabic copy of the work translated by the Reverend G. P. Badger has been in my possession for many years, and is much at the disposal of the Government.

No. 402.

No. 423-127, dated Muscat, 11th July 1872.

From—Her Britannic Majesty's Political Agent and Consul, Muscat,

To—Her Britannic Majesty's Political Resident in the Persian Gulf.

I HAVE the honor to transmit herewith a translation of an account of the Ibadhi sect of Mahomedans peculiar to Oman, which I found in an Arabic Manuscript work written by a native of that principality.

2. The peculiar bearing of this sect on the Political History of Oman, and the meagreness of published information concerning it, may perhaps induce you to think the paper worth submitting to Government.

No. 403.

An account of the Tenets of the Ibadhi sect of Oman.

FROM a manuscript Arabic work entitled "The Keshf-ul-Ghummeh of the Sheikh Sirhan bin Said bin Sirhan bin Mohammed-el-Alawi, a native of Oman," translated with prefatory Memorandum and Notes by E. C. Ross, Political Agent, Muscat.

PREFATORY REMARKS.

A large proportion of the Arabs inhabiting Oman, indeed the majority, belong to the sect of Mahomedans called Ibadhi. The origin, rise, and distinctive doctrines of this particular sect seem to have been little known to European authors until very recent times. This is the more remarkable that the form of religion has, since its adoption in Oman, in the highest degree

influenced the destiny of the people. From their peculiar opinions regarding the succession of "Imams" arose their form of Government under a head at once endowed with spiritual and temporal authority. It is evident how desirable it is that the fullest possible light should be thrown on this remarkable element in connection with the history of Oman.

The only clear and correct account of this sect we owe to the Reverend G. P. Badger, who, in an Appendix to his work* on Oman, has given an account of the sect, and dispelled many erroneous ideas.

Previous writers have touched on the subject, but either very cursorily, or, where more fully, with a large admixture of fallacy.

By † Niebuhr the sect is mentioned as that of "Beiassi," Beiadi or Abadi, the "principal sect in Oman," but his notice of it is short and not wholly correct.

In Wilsted's Travels ‡ they are mentioned as "Khuwarajites," and the following remark occurs:—

"Their own Imam they regard in two points of view; as a temporal governor, and an absolute indefeasibly appointed sovereign whose authority is of God."

The treatise on the Ibadhi tenets, a translation of which is now given, is extracted from a manuscript work of a native of Oman, the Sheikh Sirhan bin Said of the Beni Alli tribe. The work is entitled "Keshf-ul-Ghumme-el-Jamal Akhbar-el-ummeh," and contains an account of several Eastern nations, and amongst other things a valuable account of the history of Oman. The author having been himself an Oman of the Ibadhi persuasion, his account of the sect may be considered of value. It will be found corroborative of the points described in Mr. Badger's exposition.

Note.—Much of the matter is common to Mahomedanism generally.

The sect was founded by Abdullah ben Ibadh, and its denomination is

Note 1.—PEDIGREE.

From *Genealogische Tabellen* of Dr. Wustenfald.

Tamim.	Obadh.
Zeid Menat.	El-Housein.
Saad-el-Fizr.	M'o'awia.
Kaab.	Kais.
Amr.	El'Ahnaf.
El-Harith [Tribe Mukais].	Tha'labeh.
Sarim.	Tey'm-el-lat.
Morra.	Ibadh.
E'Nazzal.	Ab'd Allah.

Whether the patronymic was originally derived from the root verb, signifying "to be white," or not, matters little, but that a notion of whiteness

Note 2.—Jariyatun fi diri 'iha lel fadh fadhi—Abyadhu min Ukhti beni Ibadhi.

A damsel in her ample shift—whiter than the sister of the tribe Benu Ibadh.

derived from the surname of the founder who was descended from the parent of the Temim tribe.

Mr. Badger corrects the mistaken notion of this sect taking their name from the Arabic word meaning white, or pure, which was very generally entertained. Benee Ibadhi is gathered from an old² couplet in the Kamus quoted by Mr. Lane.

Abdullah bin Ibadhi was a man of learning, and apparently a sincere reformer. His doctrines were based on those of the Kharyites or Seceders which he wished to free from extravagant and irrational errors. Still many essential points are retained, such as the doctrines concerning Imams or spiritual leaders.

In so far the Ibadhis may be reckoned reformed Kharyites, but the latter term, though applied to them by the orthodox, would by no means be admitted by themselves.

The commentary of the Koran in use amongst the priests of the Ibadhiyeh is that of Zemakshiri who was of the Motezite sect of Kharijites.

Four subdivisions of the Ibadhi sect are mentioned in a work quoted by Mr. Badger, but these no longer exist; the sub-
The Kitab-el-Milal. sects having become united in the time of Sey-
 yid Saeed ben Ahmed, the Imam, under the auspices of a priest, the Sheikh Ja'ad ben Khamis-el-Kharusee.

As a general rule, the Yemen tribes embraced the Ibadhi religion, whilst those from Najd were more inclined to the orthodox sect. In recent times some of the latter have adopted the Wahabee religion.

The Imams of the Ibadhiyeh were almost invariably selected from Yemen families. At the present time the religious title is in abeyance.

With regard to doctrine, it is thought that the dissertation of the Sheikh Sirhan may throw additional light on this part of the subject. Perhaps the most important feature as regards their history is their rejection of the Khalifates of Othman and Ali and their assumption of the right to elect their own "Imams," whom they entitle "Imams of the Moslems." The so-elected Imam has had usually also political power.*

A point much insisted on by Ibadhi teachers is that the simple profession of belief cannot cover criminal conduct, and that sin, whether of believer or infidel, is followed by punishment, unless, in the case of the former, he publicly repents of his sins.

The discrepancies between theory and practice in the religious observances of this sect may have caused some misapprehension. Whilst many professed Ibadhis exhibit considerable laxity and license still, when the priests can have their will they affect a puritan austerity and strictness, and would, if they had the power, enforce their views with great harshness. In the matters of drinking of liquor, smoking, raiment, &c., the Ibadhi Muttawas, or priests, have proved themselves, when they had the opportunity, as bigoted and intolerant as their confreres of the Wahabee sect.

This refers to modern practice, but the founder of the sect seems to have aimed at rational reform according to his lights, and many of the extreme and intolerant opinions of other sects have no place in that of the Ibadhis; such fictions as the journey of the Prophet to Heaven are rejected as merely figurative. On the whole the doctrines promulgated by Abdullah ben Ibadhi are characterized by a puritanic but not wholly intolerant spirit.

(Sd.) E. C. Ross,

Political Agent at Muscat.

May 1872.

Translation from the Keshf-ul-Ghummeh-el-Jama-el-Akhbar-el-ummeh of the Sheikh Sirhan ben sa'id-el-Alawi of Oman.

CHAPTER XXIX.

ON the tenets of the Ibadhi sect, whose is the true religion, founded on the book and the law, and concurrent testimony.

The sect is denominated Ibadhi after the Imam of the Muslims, Abdullah

* The first three are properly included in the general term of Khawarij.

† From Jahm ben Safwan.

‡ The Râfidhi is a sect of the Shiahs of El Kufeh so called from having forsaken one Zeyd ben Ali when he forbade them to speak against the companions of the Prophet. The term is applied to those who abuse Omer and Abu Bekr.

ben Ibad ben Teym-el-Lat-ben Tha labeh ben Rahat-el-Elinaf ben Kais-el-Temimi. He it was who withdrew from all the various erring sects such as* the Mo'tezeliyeh, the Kaderiyeh, the Sefatiyeh, the Jahmiyeh,† the Khawarij Rowafidh, and the Shiah.‡

He was the first to expose their false doctrines and to nullify the banefulness of their heresies by convincing arguments and the clearest demonstration.

He grew to manhood in the time of Mawiyeh ben Ali Safivan and lived to the time of Abd-el-Malek-bin Murwân,* to whom he wrote his celebrated epistles and exhortations on moral conduct.

* From A.D. 661 to A.D. 705.

The origin of the sect is traced up to Abdullah ben-el-Abbass and Abooshâtha jabir-bin Zeyd. It derives from the people of Nahrawan† and Nakhileh and from the survivors from the fields of Safin‡ and-el-§ Jamal. Further from the "companions," such as Ammâr bin Yâsir Khozey meh bin Thabib (The-Shaha detein) Mahomed and Abdullah ben Mes'ud Hadifeh bin-el-Yemon, Ma'ath ben Hebl, Abd-er-Rehman-bin Owf, Selman, the Persian Bilat, the Abyssinian, Sâhib the Greek, and Aisheh, mother of the Faithful. Also from the accepted and well approved Khalifehs Abu Bekr and Omer, the companions of the Flight, and the Ansars or co-adjutors, may God be pleased with them all.

Abdullah bin Ibadh confuted the several fallacies in the doctrines of the various heretical sects, which have been shown in a previous part of this work. He taught that Faith (Imam) consists both in word and deed,|| and in following the precepts of traditional Law.

|| i.e., that what is confessed in words as right must also be acted on.

In this religion there is no sanction excusing any shortcoming in respect of it. Nor is it permitted falsely to avow it. Nor to give away to the passions; for this religion requires that the paths of righteousness be followed, and also belief in the following, viz.—

Articles of belief.

In God and his Angels; in His Scriptures and Prophets; in Paradise and Hell; in His promises and warnings; in the Resurrection and the Judgment and the last Day; in the messages brought by the Prophets from their Lord. It is also necessary to believe that the Korân is the word of God sent down to His Apostle Mahomed; that His Rewards are unrivalled, as His punishments are unequalled, and that the mercies He vouchsafes are great, even as the trials He imposes are great. Also that God is the creator of all things. There is none other than He, His promises are not broken, nor His threats unfulfilled, for His word is true; that all that has been revealed through Mahomed ben Abdullah is manifest truth.

The most High God: eyes perceive him not, but he comprehendeth the vision.¶ He is All-knowing, All-wise. The limits of the Heavens contain Him not, He is God. There is none other God than He, the one, the Mighty. He is the Creator who maketh all things and giveth form thereto. Who raiseth up and finally disposeth of all. Life is His gift, and He causeth to die. He is the Living who dieth not, All-powerful. One and everlasting unbegotten and unbegetting. All-powerful to do that He willeth. Imagination comprehendeth Him not, nor do created forms resemble Him. Neither movement nor repose can be attributed to him. All in earth and Heaven is His, and that which is between. He knoweth all things before they exist. Time changeth him not. Possessor of might, majesty, and power. Undying, without compeer, companion, or offspring, His word goeth forth and what He willeth is. Praise be to Him in whose hand is power over all things, to whom all things revert.

¶ Koran VI., 103.

The mental perception attains not to the knowledge of His nature.

The ** religion of Islam also is based on Faith. This †† consists in testifying that there is but one God, without copartner, that Mahomed was his servant and messenger sent to guide to the true religion, making it manifest to people of all creeds regardless of the scoff of the infidel. Since the religion was brought from God, it is manifest truth. No doubt nor uncertainty attaches to it. As to the coming Hour,

** Faith.

†† The orthodox describe Faith to consist in belief, 1st, in God; 2nd, His Angles; 3rd, Scriptures; 4th, Prophets; 5th, Resurrection and his Decrees.

there is no doubt of that, nor that God will raise the dead from their graves. But Islam in its completeness requires the practice of the following observances:—

Religious Observances.

Firstly.—Prayer with its accompanying rites, conditions; such as the necessary purifications and washings, observance of appointed times, selecting a pure place, and turning towards the Kibleh.

- 1 Prayer; 2, Almsgiving; 3, Fasting; 4, Pilgrimage.

Conditions of Prayer.

1. Members of the body must be free from impurity.
2. Garments must be clean.
3. A clean place is necessary.
4. Fixed times must be observed.
5. The face must be turned towards the Kibleh.

Prayer must be offered with earnest intention, and any word or deed calculated to affect the perfection of the act must be avoided. It is needful to understand the essential principles of prayer, to discriminate between those forms prescribed for persons at home and those for journeying. To know the observances for Fridays according to the ordinances of the Almy as laid down by His Apostle and the just "Imams" who followed him. The believer should be acquainted with the forms of prayer for festivals, for the dead, and those to be repeated in times of trouble. Also the distinctions of voluntary and supererogatory prayers, and the rest as enjoined by the Prophet.

Alms.

Secondly.—Alms.* The payment of Zekat or Legal alms from such property as the Law ordains. The obligations regarding this must be understood and the Zekat paid to the proper parties where the Nisab †

* Alms are of two kinds, zekat or legal alms, and Sadakat or voluntary. The first being divided by law on fixed conditions.

† The property must reach a certain value in cattle called Nosab.

‡ Six pounds. This is paid at the termination of the Fast of Ramadhan.

§ Alms are levied on five things, 1, cattle; 2, money; 3, corn; 4, fruits; 5, merchandize, The Ibadhis should pay to their Imam."

(Estate) reaches the full value, the proper proportion being paid from the flocks.

The Zekat-el-Fitr also must be paid, that is a Saá ‡ measure from the consumption of each person. The dole to be given to the proper

persons among the poor.§

Fasting.

Thirdly.—Fasting, which consists in keeping the fast of Ramadhan, with sobriety and abnegation, and in all things attending to what is laid down, and abstaining from all that is forbidden by God and His Prophet; with knowledge of the proper rites.

Pilgrimage.

Fourthly.—Pilgrimage to the Holy House of God for those who are in a ||

|| Amongst the Ibadhis a person must have amassed sufficient for expenses and one year's ordinary expenditure in addition before making the pilgrimage.

¶ In Minavally the pilgrim throws three stones typical of Ibrahim driving away Satan who sought to tempt him.

** The five chief points to be observed are:—

- | | |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| 1. The spirit or intention. | 3. Shaving in Minavally. |
| 2. Praying on Mt. Arafat. | 4. Circuit of the temple. |

5. Running seven times from Safa to Merwa.

†† 2. After donning the Ibram or pilgrim's dress the pilgrim must kill no game, and not even the vermin on their bodies under penalty of expiatory offerings.

position to perform it, with the enjoined conditions, namely, abstaining from sin, tarrying on Arafat, visiting the Temple and making the circuit, and throwing the stones.¶

These rites must be accompanied by understanding of the obligations** and laws of the pilgrimage such as making atone-

ment for slaying of game †† or the cutting down of trees.

Religious Precepts and Laws.

Generally it is necessary to observe the precepts of the Koran as to gifts to relations and parental piety, and acting righteously and avoiding evil. Also as to the Jihad or warring against infidels, and rendering their dues to kinsfolk,

wayfarers, &c. Instituted observances and civil laws must be attended to, including of wine or other intoxicating liquor, also abstaining from food, or wearing of apparel forbidden by the Koran.

* * * * *

It is forbidden to wail, beat the face, rend the garments, or tear the hair (in grief). It is forbidden to make pilgrimage to the tomb of any save the Prophet. Women are forbidden to adorn themselves for any but their husbands, saving the wearing of a finger ring and anointing the eyes with callyrium. It is incumbent to salute the Faithful and return their salute. Silken clothes and gold are forbidden to men. In fine the believer must avoid all that God has forbidden, whether mentioned or omitted.

Doctrine.

* On this point the Ibadhis differ from Sunnites.

It is essential to be free from the error of those who hold that good and evil are of God, and that all sins are capable of expiation.*

Those who do the right, whether written or unwritten, should receive support.

It is necessary to be clear of the errors of the sect of the Sefatiyeh, † who believe that persons who indulge in things forbidden by God and violate His prohibitions may still be in the faith, and who doubt His promises and warnings.

† The Sefatians or Attributists comprise Asharians, Mushebbehites, Keramians, Jabarians, and Morjians.

The false doctrines of the sect called Morjiyeh ‡ are also renounced by the believers (Ibadhi), for they pretend that God will punish them for a limited period, after

which He will release them from torment and cause them to enter paradise, receiving them after being angered against them.

Let the errors of the sect of the Shiah be repudiated. They who pretend that God has commanded recognition of Vice-Regents, executors of His will on earth, and obedience to them.

They believe that God has bestowed on these Vice-Regents (notwithstanding they be sinners treading the paths of error) power and dominion on earth, and that those who acknowledge and follow the Vice-Regents are pardoned their sins through their merits.

The false doctrines also must be shunned of those who assert the Koran to have an outward and apparent and an inward and hidden meaning, the former known to mankind in general, but the latter only to God's inspired Vice-Regents, by whom it is revealed to their faithful followers. They hold also that God at no time leaves the world without an inspired Vice-Regent. These the tenets of the Ismailiyeh, § a sect of the Rafidhis. The latter are heretics, who deny Abu Bekr and Omar, calling them oppressors who kept the rightful heirs from the Imamate. As to the Vicars of

§ Ismailians called by the Crusaders "Assassins" from "Hashishin," i.e., eater of Hashish. The word assassin is said to have been so adopted.

|| i. e., Mahdi.

Azrekites so called from Nafa ben Azrek, a sect formerly found at Kuteef.

i. e., countries or dwellings of infidels.

God on earth, they believe that a man || will appear in the latter days bringing erifications of their sayings. Another sect of errors is needful to be avoided, that of those who like the Azarekeh assert that persons dwelling in abodes not governed by the rules sent down by God will not be accepted of God; that their good deeds will not avail them, nor are any such meet for reward, neither are their sins forgiven. They assert that God will not excuse any for remaining therein unless they remove, and that those who die before removal are infidels. But that those who have removed even though they be murderers or adulterers, or thieves, are Muslims, and have their reward with God, and that in the abode to which they have removed none shall be accounted impious or wicked. It is even as if they were in the house of the Apostle of God. These Azarekeh also reject

stoning (for adultery) and the beating of the drinker of intoxicating liquor, but allow attack on those who are inimical to their doctrines. These heresies must be avoided.

The Ibadhis renounce the false teaching of those who hold that Muslims who commit mortal sins are to be accounted neither as Believers nor yet Infidels (but in a middle state), and that God will punish this class of sinners otherwise than infidels are punished.

Note.—The orthodox hold such persons not to be infidels. The Kharejites considered them infidels. The sect of Motazilites arose holding the middle view.

The Ibadhi sect oppose their false teaching, who say that God is not the author of their actions, but that they themselves originate them, and that God does not guide the Believers, nor distinguish them by His guiding mercy; but that guidance to Truth and wandering to error are alike optional, to choose which they will, and that God willeth not the actions of His servants, but that they are free to act in opposition to His will. These are the heresies of the Kadiriyyeh and Motezeleh and the like.

It is heresy to assert that God compels His servants to acts of obedience or sin. It is also heresy to assert that God knoweth not all things before they happen, such are the tenets of the Jahmiyyeh and the like which must be avoided. It is needful to renounce and be clear of all who reject the Muslims and scoff at their religion. Also to renounce all who do not take the part of the Muslims, * and who do not acknowledge the true "Imam," † or who fail to aid those who do the right whether laid down or not.

* Meaning the Ibadhiyyeh.
† Imam of the Ibadhiyyeh.

The foregoing are the Laws and Ordinances handed down to us by the just one from another. We do not impose our religion on children of perdition. We do not submit to the guidance of the worldly. We have not derived our belief from the foolish and ignorant.

We have heard the Lord of mankind say in his perspicuous book:—

"All ye who believe, fear God and be with the just. Take no part with the licentious who work iniquity on earth and prosper not."

We follow the just whose truth is known, and whose justice is renowned; who are of excellent conduct and knowledge, the righteous, pious, and immaculate, excelling in wisdom and nobleness, in probity and integrity, in meekness and humility, who earnestly attend to religious duties and observances, who are in the odour of religious learning, who have made religion manifest to mankind, and cleansed it of the impure and handed it down from generation to generation. We have followed the right with truthfulness and found it the most excellent path.

We announce salvation to those who follow the truth, and woe and ruin to those who swerve from it. To the latter we promise perdition and rejection on the Day of Judgment; and we seek direction of Almighty God, and I ask forgiveness of Him and repent of all my sins. God bless Mahomed His chosen apostle and his family and companions. Blessings on the Angles and Prophets and all Believers from the beginning to the end of time.

No. 404.

No. 2383P., dated Fort William, 23rd December 1872.

From—Officiating Under-Secretary to the Government of India, Foreign Dept.,

To—Secretary to the Government of Bombay.

WITH reference to your letter No. 6273, dated 31st October 1872, I am directed to request that the thanks of the Government of India may be conveyed to Lieutenant-Colonel Ross, Political Agent, Muscat, for his valuable and interesting translation of the Arabic work containing an account of the tenets of the Ibadhi sect of Oman, and for his preface to the same.

POL. 405-406. Account of the tenets of the Ibadhi Sect of Oman.

No. 405.

Nos. 2384P.-2385P., dated Fort William, 23rd December 1872.

From—Officiating Under-Secretary to the Government of India, Foreign Dept.,

To—Secretaries to the Calcutta Asiatic Society and Public Library.

I AM directed to forward herewith a copy of a paper giving an account of the tenets of the Ibadhi sect of Oman, translated from an Arabic manuscript work by Lieutenant-Colonel Ross, Political Agent, Muscat, together with a preface thereto prepared by that officer.

No. 406.

No. 249, dated Fort William, 27th December 1872.

From—Government of India,

To—Secretary of State for India.

WE have the honor to forward a copy of a letter* from the Bombay Government, submitting an account of the tenets of the Ibadhi sect of Oman, translated from an Arabic manuscript work by Lieutenant-Colonel Ross, our Political Agent at Muscat.

* No. 6273, dated 31st October 1872.

2. We have thanked Lieutenant-Colonel Ross for his valuable and interesting translation and for the preface thereto.